GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

November 06th, 2026
Week 45
Volume 282, Issue 1260

Highlights:

- **Crude Retreats**
- **Freight Recovers**
- **Steel Softens**
- **Supply Scarce**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"The art of being wise is the art of knowing what to overlook."

- William James

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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BIDS HOLD FAST AGAINST THE TIDE

Last week's improving recycling sentiment has encountered a changing international backdrop. Crude oil has retreated sharply, domestic steel prices have weakened across several destinations, and freight continues to fluctuate. Yet recycling indications remain unchanged across all four markets. Buying appetite remains healthy, particularly in Bangladesh, although the persistent shortage of available candidates continues to prevent stronger sentiment from translating into fresh transactions.

Oil supplied the week's most striking movement. Brent retreated towards USD 99 per barrel on Friday, while WTI traded around USD 91, reversing much of last week's advance. Expectations of easing Middle Eastern tensions encouraged the correction, although renewed security incidents in the Gulf and Strait of Hormuz demonstrated that shipping risks remain unresolved. Lower crude may ease operating expenses, but uncertainty surrounding regional passage continues to influence tanker employment and owners' recycling decisions.

Dry freight offered mixed signals. The Baltic Dry Index recovered to 2,740 on Thursday, November 5, from 2,712 a week earlier, having fallen to 2,590 during the intervening sessions. Capesizes strengthened to 4,191 and Panamaxes improved to 1,956, while Supramaxes eased to 1,824. The uneven recovery continues to provide ageing vessels with trading alternatives, restricting the supply of recycling candidates.

Steel markets moved against recyclers. Indian plate declined considerably during the week, while Pakistan recorded a further correction and Chinese steel continued to soften. Bangladesh remained unchanged, although a strengthening Dollar placed additional pressure on the Taka amid substantial foreign currency requirements for energy imports. Weaker steel realisations are restricting purchasing flexibility, even as recycling price indications remain unchanged.

India also faced an important regulatory hurdle. On November 4, the European Parliament's ENVI Committee voted to object to the proposed inclusion of Indian ship recycling yards on the European approved list, citing environmental concerns over beaching methods. The objection is not a final rejection. A full parliamentary vote is expected later this month, while the final binding decision remains subject to EU Member State approval. The development introduces uncertainty into Alang's expanding compliance ambitions.

At the beaches, Bangladesh continues to demonstrate the strongest conventional buying appetite, supported by expectations of improving seasonal demand. Pakistan remains static amid limited fresh supply, while India continues to pursue opportunities in specialist and higher-value vessels. Turkey maintains its selective approach. Physical activity nevertheless continued, with a sizeable tanker arriving at Chattogram, additional tonnage reaching Alang and a previously secured bulker completing delivery at Gadani.

The overall market remains stable despite softer steel and changing energy conditions. Buyers are maintaining their positions, but freight earnings and second-hand alternatives continue to discourage owners from releasing ageing ships. Bangladesh has the confidence, India retains its specialist strengths, and Pakistan and Turkey remain measured. The bids are holding their ground. The missing ingredient remains a steady supply of willing sellers.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 45 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

CHATTOGRAM'S APPETITE DEFIES THE SEASON

Buyer Confidence.

Chattogram continues to display encouraging recycling sentiment, with end buyers maintaining strong price indications and a healthy appetite for suitable vessels. The market has carried its improved confidence into November despite the continuing shortage of available candidates. Recyclers remain prepared to compete for appropriate bulkers, tankers and container vessels, although limited supply continues to restrict opportunities to translate buying interest into fresh commitments. Conventional recycling indications remain unchanged across all categories, preserving Bangladesh's leading position in the sub-continent. The resilience of the market reflects continuing yard requirements and buyer confidence rather than any substantial improvement in domestic steel consumption.

Dollar Pressure.

Local steel remained unchanged at BDT 66,000 per ton throughout the week, providing a stable foundation for vessel pricing without additional upward momentum. Currency conditions, however, have become more challenging. The Dollar strengthened against the Taka, with Bangladesh Bank's spot reference approaching BDT 124.62 on November 5, compared with approximately BDT 124.22 a week earlier. Substantial energy import requirements continue to contribute to demand for foreign currency, placing additional pressure on local purchasing costs. Although recyclers retain strong buying intentions, the combination of elevated energy expenses and currency pressure requires careful margin management, particularly while domestic finished-steel demand has yet to demonstrate a sustained recovery.

Seasonal Prospects.

Attention continues to turn towards the approaching dry season, when improving weather conditions and anticipated construction activity are expected to support steel consumption and yard operations. Sentiment is increasingly positive, although the anticipated seasonal improvement remains an expectation rather than an established recovery. At the waterfront, the sizeable 44,411 LDT tanker ERA arrived on November 4, adding substantial tonnage to Chattogram's existing pipeline. The 9,759 LDT wood chip carrier CRIMSON SATURN and 3,421 LDT LPG tanker B-LPG SOPHIA remain recorded as earlier arrivals. These movements are encouraging for physical yard activity, but the distinction between arrivals and completed deliveries remains important.

Chattogram enters the coming weeks with the strongest conventional buying position, stable domestic plate and expectations of a more favourable operating season. The principal concerns remain currency pressure, energy costs and the availability of suitable recycling candidates. Seasonal demand may provide additional support, but stronger steel consumption and consistent vessel supply will ultimately determine whether current optimism translates into greater activity. For now, Bangladesh has the appetite and the confidence to compete. The next requirement is a steadier flow of ships.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



ALANG NAVIGATES EUROPEAN HEADWINDS

Regulatory Crosswind.

An important development emerged this week in India's continuing efforts to secure inclusion of its ship recycling facilities on the European approved list. On November 4, the European Parliament's Environment, Public Health and Food Safety (ENVI) Committee voted to object to the proposed inclusion of Indian yards, citing environmental concerns surrounding beaching methods. The objection represents a political hurdle rather than a final legal rejection. The proposal is expected to proceed to a full Parliament Plenary vote later this month, while the final binding decision remains subject to EU Member State approval. The development introduces uncertainty into a compliance initiative that has attracted considerable industry attention and carries potential long-term importance for Alang.

Plate Retreats.

Domestic steel conditions provided considerably less encouragement this week. Alang plate declined from INR 43,300 per ton last Friday to INR 40,700 by November 6, having briefly recovered from its midweek low. The Dollar equivalent also weakened despite an improvement in the Rupee, which benefited from lower crude prices and renewed foreign investment inflows. The softer steel market limits recyclers' purchasing flexibility, particularly when competing against stronger conventional buying positions in Bangladesh and Pakistan. China's continuing steel-price correction adds to the cautious regional backdrop. Conventional recycling indications nevertheless remain unchanged, with Indian buyers maintaining discipline rather than chasing tonnage at levels unsupported by recoverable material values.

Specialist Appeal.

Physical activity continues to demonstrate the diversity of Alang's recycling market. The 12,915 LDT chemical tanker STOLT CONFIDENCE arrived on November 6, while the 9,708 LDT OIVO was delivered on the same date. The 12,915 LDT general cargo vessel D/V SENCER 1, recorded as being towed by tug, was delivered on November 3. These movements reinforce the importance of India's established expertise in handling specialised vessels, alongside reefers, gas carriers and other units offering additional non-ferrous or equipment value. Such candidates can command commercial attention beyond the conventional recycling price structure, particularly where technical handling and compliance requirements influence owners' decisions.

Alang's overall position remains broadly consistent with recent weeks. While conventional competition is challenging and domestic steel has weakened, Indian recyclers continue to benefit from established specialist capabilities and infrastructure developed to meet increasingly demanding recycling standards. The European listing proposal remains unresolved, and its eventual outcome could carry important implications for participating facilities. For now, India's commercial strengths remain vessel-specific. The regulatory winds may have shifted, but Alang's specialist market continues to provide a course of its own.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

GADANI WAITS FOR THE NEXT WAVE

Supply Stalls.

Gadani has experienced another relatively uneventful week, with recycling sentiment remaining broadly static and the availability of fresh candidates continuing to disappoint. Although buyers retain an interest in commercially suitable vessels, the market has shown little urgency to pursue additional tonnage. The more measured approach follows the substantial buying activity recorded earlier in the year, when a greater number of vessels were secured to satisfy immediate yard requirements. Bangladesh continues to provide strong competition for conventional candidates, but Pakistani recyclers remain capable of responding when appropriate opportunities emerge. The absence of fresh supply is therefore restricting activity rather than reflecting a meaningful deterioration in underlying demand.

Plate Eases.

Domestic steel prices weakened further during the reporting period, with local plate declining from PKR 188,000 per ton last Friday to PKR 183,000 by November 6. The corresponding Dollar equivalent also retreated, placing additional pressure on recoverable steel margins. Imported scrap remains an alternative source of raw material for domestic steel production, while cautious finished-steel demand continues to limit purchasing flexibility. The latest inflation figures offered some encouragement, with Pakistan's annual CPI easing to 9.6% in October from 10.3% in September. Although the improvement provides a measure of macroeconomic relief, financing considerations and weaker steel values continue to favour disciplined vessel acquisition rather than aggressive bidding.

Pipeline Moves.

Gadani's waterfront nevertheless recorded another delivery, with the 5,700 LDT bulk carrier SPARROW delivered on November 5 following its earlier arrival in October. The movement represents the progression of previously secured tonnage and provides welcome activity for local recycling facilities. However, the absence of additional fresh candidates continues to limit the development of a more consistent vessel pipeline. Recycling indications remain unchanged, with buyers apparently content to maintain their position until suitable opportunities become available.

Pakistan consequently enters the second week of November with stable underlying sentiment but little transactional momentum. Softer domestic steel and limited candidate availability provide few reasons for buyers to become more aggressive, even as the easing inflation environment offers some encouragement. Gadani retains the infrastructure, purchasing capacity and interest to compete. What remains missing is a sufficient selection of ships to put those capabilities to work. The market is holding its position, but it cannot advance without supply.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

ALIAGA HOLDS A STEADY HELM

Aliaga maintained a stable recycling market this week, with buyers continuing to exercise caution when considering fresh vessel acquisitions. Domestic finished-steel consumption remains subdued, although Turkish mills have shown renewed interest in imported scrap for December shipment. Several deep-sea scrap cargoes were reportedly concluded, reflecting replacement buying rather than a broader recovery in steel demand. Recycling indications remain unchanged, with buyers maintaining a selective approach.

Buying Discipline.

Turkey's annual inflation edged higher to 29.77% in October from 29.73% in September, interrupting its recent downward trend. The central bank's October interest rate reduction to 36% has provided modest financing relief, although borrowing costs remain elevated. Continued Lira weakness and cautious domestic steel demand restrict purchasing flexibility, while lower international crude prices may offer some relief to industrial operating costs.

Inflation Nudges.

Aliaga retains its established position for European and Mediterranean tonnage, supported by geographical proximity, specialist handling capabilities and environmental compliance considerations. These advantages remain important when owners assess recycling destinations beyond conventional pricing. Overall sentiment remains stable, with recyclers awaiting stronger domestic steel demand before considering more aggressive purchases.

Regional Advantage.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly - Market Rankings

For Week 45 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	515 / LDT	535 / LDT	545 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	505 / LDT	525 / LDT	535 / LDT
3	India	**Improving**	470 / LDT	490 / LDT	500 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	290 / LDT	300-310 / LDT	320 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- ***69.16 million tonnes of steel*** *recovered through ship recycling at Alang could produce approximately 574,000 km of railway track, enough to circle the Earth's equator more than 14 times.*

- ***72.55 million tonnes of CO2 emissions*** *avoided through ship recycling at Alang is nearly twice the United Kingdom's electricity supply sector emissions in 2025.*

- ***100 million tonnes of iron ore*** *extraction avoided through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to approximately 590 fully laden Capesize bulk carrier cargoes, assuming 170,000 tonnes per shipment.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
November 24 – Guru Nanak's Birthday	November 07 – November 14 November 23 – November 30

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 16 – Victory Day	November 07 – November 10 November 23 – November 26

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	01 January – New Year

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of November 06, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Stolt Confidence	12,915	Chemical Tanker	Arrived November 06
2	Oivo	9,708	Mining	***Delivered November 06***
3	D/V Sencer 1 Towed By Tug Sea	12,915	General Cargo	***Delivered November 03***

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of November 06, 2026

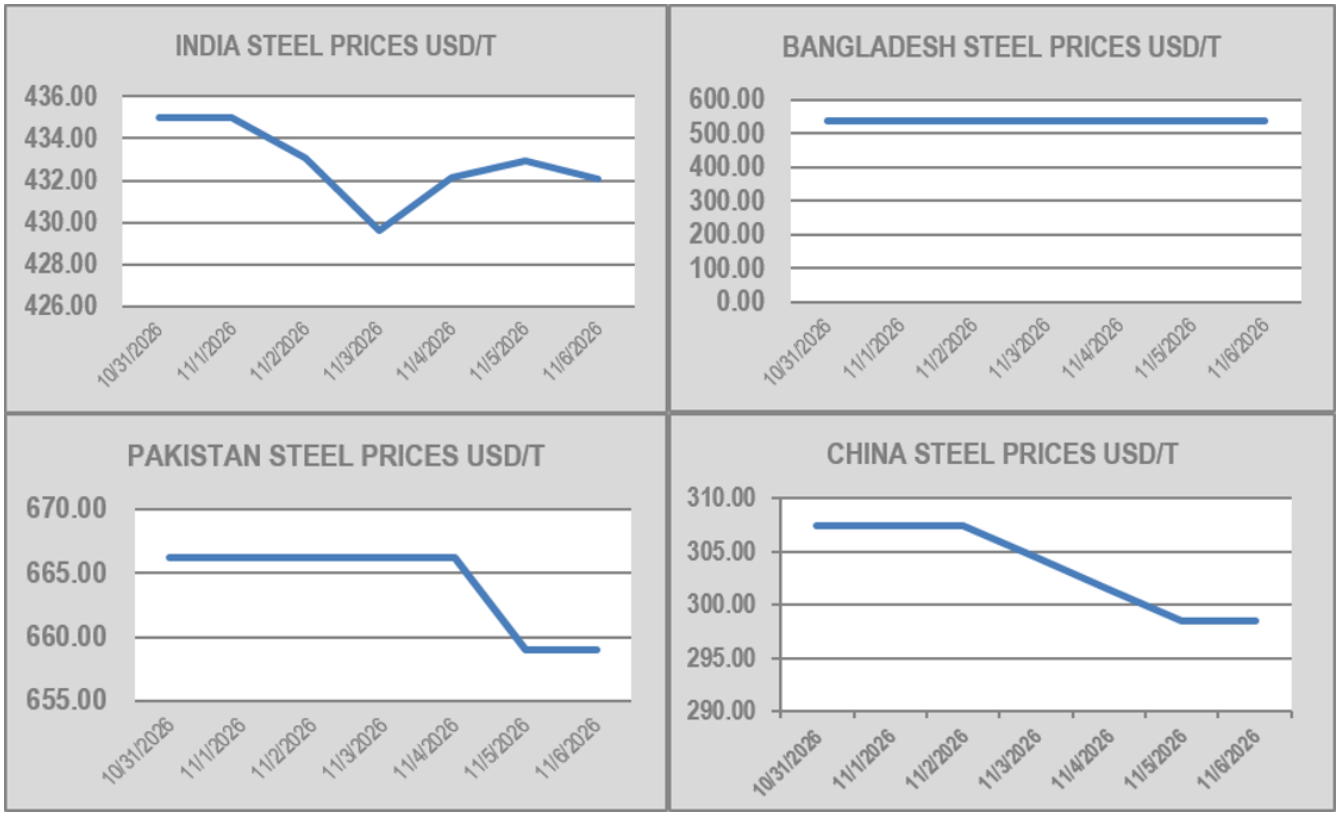
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	ERA	44,411	Tanker	Arrived November 04
2	Crimson Saturn	9,759	Wood Chip Carrier	Arrived October 28
3	B-LPG Sophia (D/VSL)	3,421	LPG Tanker	Arrived September 28

GADANI - Port Position as of November 06, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Sparrow	5,700	Bulk Carrier	***Delivered November 05***

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
10/31/2026	434.97	41,300.00	666.19	185,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47
11/1/2026	434.97	41,300.00	666.19	185,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47
11/2/2026	433.09	41,100.00	666.19	185,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47
11/3/2026	429.60	40,700.00	666.19	185,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	304.54
11/4/2026	432.12	40,900.00	666.19	185,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	301.43
11/5/2026	432.94	40,900.00	658.98	183,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	298.56
11/6/2026	432.06	40,700.00	658.98	183,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	298.56



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